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DECCAN Chronicle

THE LARGEST CIRCULATED ENGLISH DAILY IN SOUTH INDIA

BENGALURU | WEDNESDAY 23 | MAY 2012



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Weather

Max: 34.1°C **Min:** 22.9°C **RH:** 37%
Rainfall: Nil

Windows

ASTROGUIDE:
Khara: Uttarayana
Tithi: Jyeshtha Shukla Dvitiya till 9.57 am
Star: Mrigashira till 6.25 pm
Yoga: Dhriti till 8.42 pm
Rahukalam: 12 noon to 1.30 pm

PRAYERS (JAMIA MASJID)
Fajar: 5.54 am **Zohar:** 1.31 pm
Asar: 4.04 pm **Maghrib:** 6.45 pm
Isha: 8.01 pm

SUNSET Today **6.40 pm**
SUNRISE Tomorrow **5.53 am**
MOONRISE Today **7.35 am**
MOONSET Tomorrow **8.41 pm**

Other stories



Actress' Kalki Koechlin (left) and Reema Sen at the photocall for the movie *Gangs of Wasseypur* at the 65th Cannes film festival on Tuesday — *AFP*

2 BRITS GO MISSING NEAR MUTTATHI

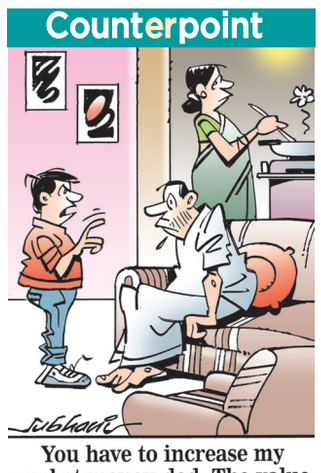
Mysore: Two British nationals went missing after they set out on a weekend boating expedition from the Muttathi forest in Mandya district on May 19. Turton Ian Richard from Huntington in the UK, working as a project manager with Tenneco Automotive India in Hosur, and his friend Michael David John Easton, working with Shell in Bengaluru, had set out on a boat to the Anchetti forest area near Denkanikottai in Tamil Nadu. They had not reached their destination till late on Tuesday evening. ■ P4

BBMP CHIEF MAY BE TRANSFERRED

Bengaluru: Some BJP corporators have allegedly prevailed upon the top leaders in the state government to transfer BBMP Commissioner M.K. Shankarlinge Gowda, who took charge only six months ago. Palike sources told *Deccan Chronicle* that the government will issue the marching orders soon after the BBMP budget. As the election code of conduct is in place because of the council elections, the announcement could be made after June 13. It is said some of the corporators are upset that Mr Gowda had handed over the investigation into some of the scams to the Technical Vigilance Committee under Commissioner.



Counterpoint



You have to increase my pocket money, dad. The value of rupee is at all-time low!



INTERNATIONAL 12
Pakistan must be part of Afghan solution: Obama

14 **SPORT**
Star striker Drogba bids adieu to Chelsea



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DEATH TRAIN: 26 DIE, 45 INJURED AS DRIVER DOZES OFF, RAMS GOODS WAGON





HORROR ON THE RAIL TRACK

AKANKSHA MEHROTRA | DC
PENUKONDA, MAY 22

The victims were labourers hailing from Koppal, Bellary, Raichur and Gadag districts

In one of the most horrifying rail accidents in recent times, 26 people were killed and over 45 injured, as the Hampi Express, which left Hubli at 6 pm on Monday, hit the rear portion of the stationary goods train at Penukonda Railway Station in the Dharmavaram- Bengaluru section.

The second class luggage-cum-brake van near the engine which took the impact of the collision caught fire and the flames engulfed the General Second Class coach nearby, catching sleeping passengers by surprise.

Most of the dead were charred beyond recognition in the fire that engulfed the coaches under the impact of the collision but Railway authorities said they were able to identify 18 of the 26 passengers killed.

Guntakal Railway Police said the victims were labourers from Koppal, Bellary, Raichur and Gadag districts of Karnataka.

Of the 26 dead, 19 are men, and include three women and three children. The unidentified bodies were from the unreserved general compartment which saw the maximum number of casualties.

A case has been booked against the loco pilot and assistant loco pilot of the ill-fated Hampi Express after preliminary investigations by the Commissioner for Railway Safety suggest that the locomotive pilot's negligence in overlooking the signal, led to the accident.

Rescue operations began within an hour and a half of the mishap, after a huge crane was rushed in from Bengaluru and mangled bogies were removed from the track and teams used cutters to free the terrified, still trapped in the coaches.



A woman breaks down after learning of the death of her husband who was travelling on the ill-fated Hampi Express, in Penukonda, Andhra Pradesh, on Tuesday Pix: *Satish B.* ■ See P2&3

₹5 LAKH EX GRATIA
Railway minister Mukul Roy said that ₹5 lakh each would be paid as ex-gratia to the kin of those died in the accident at the railway station and one family member would be given a railway job.

FIR AGAINST PILOT
Hindupur Railway Police registered a FIR against loco pilot M.Y. Ratnam and assistant loco pilot Balraj, who were among the injured and undergoing treatment. More names will be added soon.

- Kushtagi MLA Amaregouda Bayyapur had a providential escape as he was in the fourth coach of Hampi Express
- Unidentified bodies kept in Anantapur

When will Rlys act on preventing accidents?

MANISH ANAND and JOHNLEE ABRAHAM | DC
NEW DELHI/BENGALURU, MAY 22

Tuesday's accident has brought the unconscionable delay in the introduction of the much needed Train Protection and Warning System (TPWS) to the fore, with Railway Minister Mukul Roy unable to set a date for the introduction of the anti-collision system.

The European system, which ensures emergency brakes are automatically applied if a locomotive driver jumps a red signal, may have saved lives Tuesday, when train driver M.Y. Ratnam, despite resting over 24 hours, hit a stationary train.

The scale of the tragedy could have been bigger, officials said, as the Hampi Express was to follow Line 1, on which Nanded Express was moving out slowly, but because "the point" set for the ill-fated train to go on Line 2 was later where a goods train was stationary, the loss of lives was minimal.

The official said the tender process for TPWS — at a cost of ₹50 lakh per kilometer - was yet to be finalised. In the 12th Five-Year-Plan, Railways will install TPWS on a 3,200 km route at an estimated cost of ₹3,200 crore. Of 2,763 train accidents in 2000-2010, human error was behind 50 per cent of them.

ALERT COP'S ACTION SAVED MANY LIVES
An alert police officer, who was travelling on the ill-fated Bengaluru-bound Hampi Express, immediately alerted the circle inspector at Penukonda from his mobile phone soon after the train collided with a goods train in Andhra Pradesh around 3.15 am. The circle inspector, with his team, rushed to the spot in no time and took up relief and rescue measures. — *BC*

Prez poll: UPA dishes up numbers

MUKESH RANJAN | DC
NEW DELHI, MAY 22

With Samajwadi Party (SP) chief Mulayam Singh Yadav sharing the dais with Prime Minister Manmohan Singh and Congress president Sonia Gandhi at an official function to mark the completion of three years of UPA-II in government, a strong political message has gone across: that the ruling alliance has succeeded in securing the required support for its presidential nominee.

But this bonhomie with the SP has pushed BSP supremo Mayawati away from the UPA; neither she nor any of her nominees attended the function at the official residence of the Prime Minister despite an invitation.

Even the chiefs of two key UPA allies — Trinamul Congress and DMK — skipped the function and instead sent their nominees.

For TMC, it was junior minister Saugata Roy and for DMK it was its floor leader in the Lok Sabha, T.R. Baalu, who were seated on the dais.

Even RJD chief Lalu Prasad had the privilege of being there on dais this time; he was seen sitting in the audience in May 2011 when the UPA-II held a function to mark the completion of its second year in government.

Congress spokesperson Renuka Chowdhury, however, denied that any message was sought to be given to anybody by having the SP chief and RJD supremo on the podium along with senior ministers and leaders of parties that have representatives in the Cabinet. ■ See P10



UPA chairperson Sonia Gandhi at the release of a report of UPA on its third anniversary in New Delhi on Tuesday. Also seen are Prime Minister Manmohan Singh, finance minister Pranab Mukherjee, home minister P. Chidambaram and SP chief Mulayam Singh Yadav — *PTI*

> We are aware that only two years are left when we will be seeking a new mandate from the people. We are fully aware that the result of that will not depend on our promises but on the nature of work done by us
>
> **— Soni Gandhi**
> UPA chairperson

- Dr Singh and Mrs Gandhi steered clear of questions whether they supported the candidature of Mr Mukherjee for the President's post. Dr Singh refused to answer whether he will be able to 'spare' Mr Mukherjee. "I will not answer any question at the moment," said Mrs Gandhi.



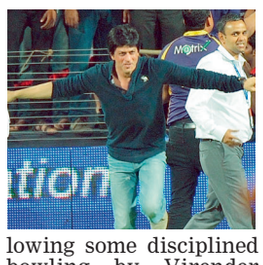
Kolkata outfit in maiden title clash

SRK's Knights ride into the final

DC CORRESPONDENT
BENGALURU, MAY 22

Kolkata Knight Rider's entered their maiden Indian Premier League final, beating the in-form Delhi Daredevils by 18 runs in the first qualifier in Pune on Tuesday.

The Knight Riders, who won the toss and elected to bat struck 162 for the loss of four wickets, following some disciplined bowling by Virender Sehwag's men. If not for a 56-run stand between Yusuf Pathan and Laxmi Shukla, the script would have been different for the Kolkata outfit.



In reply, Delhi Daredevils' famed batting found the going tough. The Daredevils start was marred at the beginning, with openers David Warner and Virender Sehwag dislodged in successive overs. Mahela Jayawardene top-scored with 40, but once he was dismissed the Daredevils lost their way.

CSK TEST FOR MIGHTY MUMBAI: There is a lot riding in the Eliminator clash between the Mumbai Indians and Chennai Super Kings. The winner of the second playoff will qualify for Friday's virtual semi-final showdown with Delhi Daredevils.